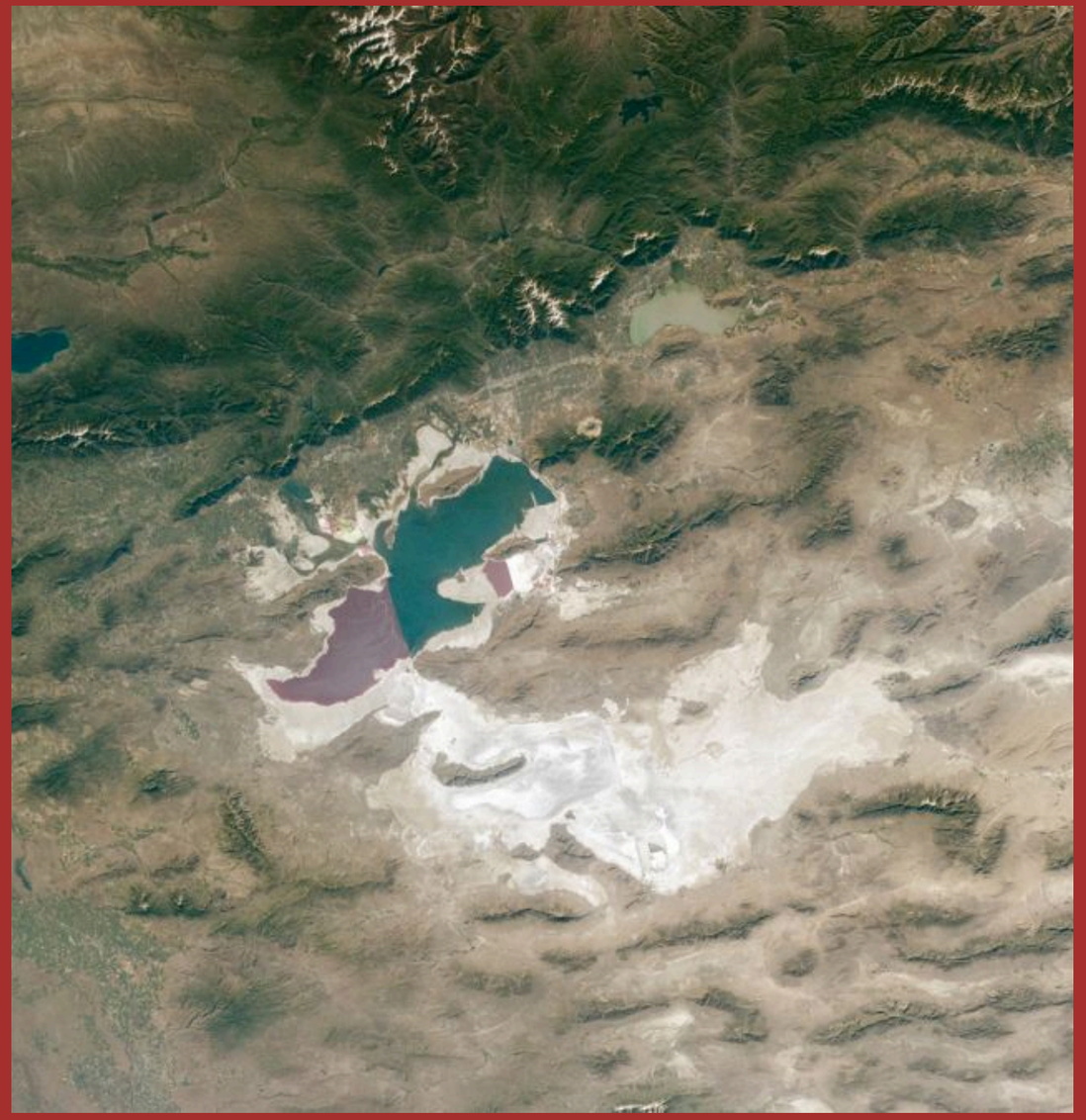
Base and Meridian

A merch line for Visit Salt Lake. Working name.
Round 1, October 28, 2026.



The Great Salt Lake from the ISS: pink north arm, blue south arm, split by the railroad causeway. NASA, 2025.

Visit Salt Lake merch today is a logo on a blank.

1 tee

The only documented piece of Visit Salt Lake apparel is the reward tee from the 2021 West of Conventional mural tour. No online store turns up, and there is no dedicated shop.

Yid, client answers, Oct 2026 · KSL and VSL on West of Conventional, 2021

If you can buy it at the airport or a local shop, it isn't it.

That's the bar. Nothing that's just a logo, nothing that looks like mall product. The taste check is Nike ACG, House of Terrors, Uuuntld and WNTD.

Yid, client answers, Oct 2026

Four parts: context, foundation, executions, build.

Visible text stays short and the reasoning lives in the notes. Anything marked (verify) came from background knowledge and gets checked before Round 2.

- **Context, slides 5 to 20.** Who does merch well right now, who got it wrong, and what we take.
- **Foundation, 21 to 32.** The parent brand, who buys, the Salt Lake symbol bank, materials and techniques.
- **Executions, 33 to 52.** Five lanes and the pieces in each, then the full line on one page.
- **Build, 53 to 60.** The 50-unit test, cost, production, legal, and the decisions we need.

What merch is now.

The brands people collect stopped treating merch as a logo on a blank. Here's who does it well, what failed, and what we take from them.

Merch became the luxury product.

- **Hermès petit h** makes one-of-one objects from leftover leather, silk and porcelain, from about $70 to $70,000.
- **Hermès Off-Piste skis**, October 2025: sycamore over an ash core, $19,300. The house sells the sport its customers actually do.
- **Loewe** turned a 2024 Instagram joke into a real tomato clutch in nappa lambskin.
- **Miu Miu** grew retail 35% in FY2025 while spending on culture, like Summer Reads books in city-specific colors with ex-libris stamps.

AnOther and Nuvo on petit h · Teton Gravity Research, 2025 · Tatler Asia on Loewe, 2024 · The Industry on Miu Miu, 2026



Kunimasa Aoki, Loewe Foundation Craft Prize 2025 winner, with his work. Credit the hands.

Technique replaces the logo.

Bottega Veneta's woven intrecciato reads as Bottega with no wordmark. Stone Island claims over 60,000 garment-dye recipes. Satisfy puts holes in a cotton tee and calls it MothTech.

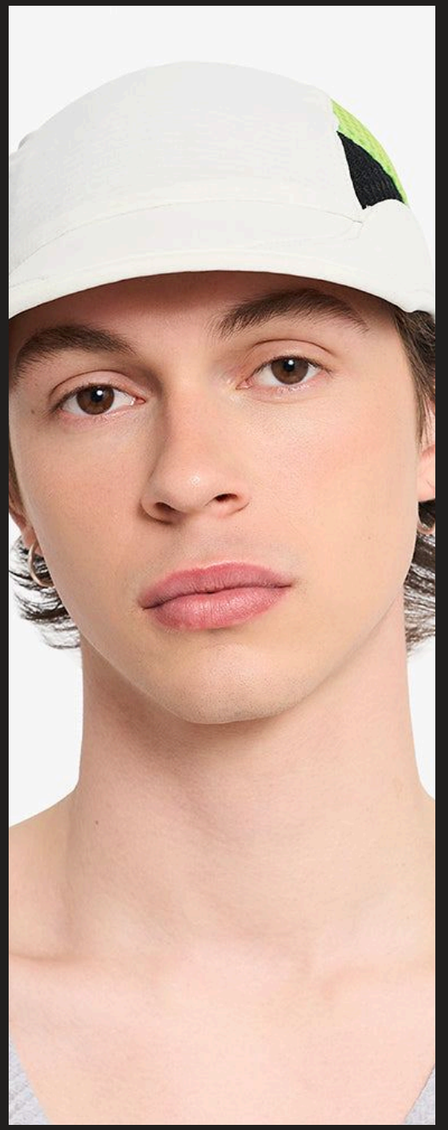
Fzine and 10 Magazine on Bottega, 2025 · Stone Island, About · Urban Industry on Satisfy · Gear Patrol on Carhartt



Satisfy MothTech tee, Chamonix goat graphic with cut-through holes, 2025.



Fort Lonesome chain stitch on a vintage Singer. The machine is the signature.



Ciele FSTCap Elite: perforated panels and reflective trim, no hardware.

Scarcity works when the rules are public.

The calendar, the password and the edition size are part of the product.

Who	The rule	The number
Supreme	Weekly drop in stores, never enough stock	Thursdays, 11am ET (verify)
Palace	Seasonal weekly drops, unpredictable mix	Summer 2026, Drop 7 on June 19
Corteiz	Password site, pop-ups announced hours ahead, swap your jacket for ours	50 Bolo puffers
Dior x Air Jordan 1	Lottery, edition size published	8,500 high, 4,700 low
Fermat FRMT	Five pieces sold through Fermat's own product	75 of each

Highsnobiety on Supreme and Corteiz · Hypebeast on Palace, 2026 · Hypebae on Dior x AJ1, 2020 · Hyper on FRMT

Graphics houses make culture merch work.

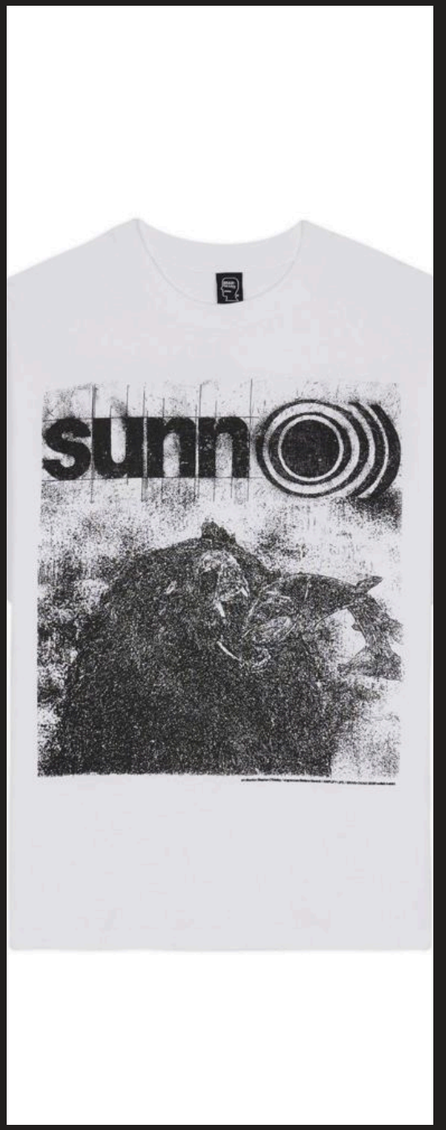
A24 hires Online Ceramics, Brain Dead and Nahmias, credits them on the product page and sews its own label inside. The film is the subject and the designer is the author.



Online Ceramics, Grateful For 60 Years tie-dye long sleeve, 2025. The brand started as bootleg Dead lot tees.



Online Ceramics x blink-182 Dude Ranch long sleeve, 2024: sleeve print plus a small chest hit.



Brain Dead x Sunn O))) tee, 2025: one-color photocopy texture, no cleanup.

Fast Company on A24 x Online Ceramics · Hypebeast HB20, Oct 2025 · Hypebeast and Highsnobiety on Marty Supreme, 2025 · Gizmodo, 2026

Tech companies turned merch into fashion.

CNN said in August 2026 that most tech merch 'lacks a clear point of view.' A place has one built in.

Company	The move	What happened
Anthropic	A washed navy cap that says 'thinking,' given away with coffee at a NYC newsstand, October 2025	Never sold. One eBay seller moved 117 at $49.99
OpenAI Supply Co.	Public since late July 2026: $15 socks to a $175 half-zip, plus an archive of 'decommissioned' pieces	Items sold out in days; a Codex set resold for $475
Perplexity Supply	Copy built on curiosity; a $135 chore jacket in 'Wonder Blue'	A designer on it compared the work to Highway 101 billboards
Fermat FRMT	A B2B software company made five 'couture' pieces	75 of each, with pre-orders before launch

CNN, Aug 17 2026 · Quartz on OpenAI Supply Co., 2026 · perplexity.supply · Hyper Studios on Fermat

Outdoor got quieter and more specific.

The loud gorpcore years are over. What's left is one good shell, one good fleece, trail runners, and not talking about it.



Nike ACG Lava Loft. ACG relaunched as its own outdoor brand in February 2026, with a Basecamp store in Beijing.



Arc'teryx System_A Drop 06, 'Run to Rock,' 2023. Arc'teryx's Shanghai Museum runs 2,400 square meters with a repair desk.



Tracksmith, The Amateur Spirit, 2021. Serious kit for serious amateurs, 'no athleisure.'



Nike ACG Fall 2026 trail lineup: earth tones and one hot accent.

Jing Daily, Feb 2026 · Outside, Sept 2026 · Jing Daily on the Arc'teryx Museum, 2024 · Glossy on Tracksmith

The best regional lines name real places and real makers.

- **Adidas Spezial** names shoes after towns, Blackburn SPZL and Manchester 89, and launched in Manchester in 2014, not London. Gary Aspden: 'culture can exist anywhere.'
- **Snow Peak Local Wear** limits each project to one regional producer, like Niigata and Iwate in 2024, and sells it in Japan only.
- **66°North** started in 1926 making gear for Icelandic fishermen. Its 2025 Fisherman's Print comes from the wear left on old coats by 'salt, storms and time at sea.'

Dazed and 032c on Spezial · WWD Japan on Snow Peak, 2024 · Hero and T3 on 66°North, 2025

Destination merch that works has a maker and an archive.

None of these is a logo on a blank. Each one lends a public mark to someone with taste.

Who	What they did	Why it works
Printed in Pittsburgh, 2023	The city licensed union printer CommonWealth Press. Shirts from $30, revenue share to the general fund	The icon came from an 1800s merchant flag in the city archives
Tokyo Tokyo	50-plus souvenirs with partner makers, and an official shop at Haneda since February 22, 2020	The city acts as curator and co-publisher
Only NY x NYC Parks	Licensed the Parks leaf and the MTA. The leaf tee has sold for a decade	Public infrastructure treated like a heritage logo
Parks Project	Public-land graphics with a giving model: about $1,000 given in 2014, nearly $3 million by 2026	A real number tied to a real place

Pittsburgh Magazine and WPXI, 2023 · Tokyo Metropolitan Government, 2020 · onlyny.com · Orange Coast and Field Mag on Parks Project

Three ways city merch goes wrong.

Each one got friendlier, cheaper or more popular than the idea could hold.

- **We ❤️ NYC, March 2023.** A refresh with a blocky sans and an emoji-style heart got mocked so hard that officials had to say it wasn't replacing Milton Glaser's original.
- **The $22 Aspen crewneck.** The town name sells for $22 to $100 on Etsy, PacSun and Abercrombie. Once the mall has it, it stops proving you were there.
- **I amsterdam.** The letters drew such crowds that the city pulled them from Museumplein on December 3, 2018.

Dezeen and Surface, 2023 · Etsy, PacSun, Abercrombie listings, 2026 · Dezeen, 2018

The Games and the teams already left a playbook.

History and a wink only. No rings, no official marks.

Reference	What happened	What we take
Salt Lake 2002 beret	Roots, $19.95, worn by the US team at the opening ceremony; lines out the door	A cheap, slightly odd hat with a story beats a logo
Paris 2024	A hat as mascot, a real design director, 75 licensees, mostly small French firms	Spread the work across local makers
Utah Jazz City Edition, 2017-18	Red rock gradient. 300 jerseys gone in 72 hours, resale at $600 on $130 retail	Utah landscape as a colorway already sells here
Venezia FC	Left Nike for Kappa to get creative control; 95% of online sales came from outside Italy	Sell the city, not the organization

ABC4 2002 retrospective · Wallpaper and WIPO on Paris 2024 · KSL on the Jazz, 2017 · Versus on Venezia FC

Utah already has people doing this well.

A Provo label went national, a Provo studio drew type for NikeLab, and a Salt Lake brand owns the premium trucker.

Who	What they've done	What it proves
Lonely Ghost, Provo, 2019	Built on 'I love you, say it back.' Ghost Grocery at Riverwoods, a Pacsun exclusive in August 2025, a Merrell shoe that September	A phrase can carry a Utah brand nationally
Actual Source, Provo	JP Haynie and Davis Ngarupe. Thermal typeface for Virgil Abloh's NikeLab Re-Creation Center, 2019; A24 Books identity, 2026	Fashion-grade type already lives in Utah County
Gigi Pip, Salt Lake, 2015	Official REDWEST hat sponsor with a Mountain Vintage Trucker; SLC Speakeasy hat bar, October 2025	A local brand already makes the hero object
Kilby Court and Kilby Block Party	25 years of all-ages shows, tees credited to local artists Chloe Monson and Tom Petersen; 25,000 to 30,000 a day at the 2026 festival	Credit the artist on every piece
Fice, downtown since 2008	Utah's only Tier One Nike account, now shifting to community events and art shows	The clubhouse already exists
Mouthwash	The Utah Jazz 2022 rebrand: motion system, type, court and jersey colorways	Utah teams already hire fashion-grade studios

PR Newswire on Lonely Ghost, 2025 · SLUG and Lampoon on Actual Source · Utah Business on Gigi Pip, 2025 · kilbycourt.com; Bailey Rogers portfolio · Salt Lake Sideways on Fice · mouthwash.studio

Hotels, restaurants and museums sell proof you were there.

Vogue Business, 2026: the product is becoming 'the souvenir of an experience rather than the experience itself.'



Ace Hotel Nalgene, 2026. Ace is credited with starting the hotel shop, and stocks 'anti-souvenirs' like Krink markers.



A24 x Houseplant stacking ashtrays and matchbook, 2026. Bar-top objects as brand carriers.



A24 Music, Primetime soundtrack on vinyl, 2026. A film studio with a record label.



Le Labo labels by Mazarine: blanks for the city and date, filled in at the counter.

Vogue Business Summit 2026, via The CFO Diary · SF Standard, Aug 20 2026 · FashionNetwork on Erewhon, 2024 · Glossy on MoMA Design Store

What people are picking up right now.

- **Real lettering over fake vintage.** PRINT's 2026 Type Report says designers are leaving 'vintage' fonts for actual signage, packaging and regional lettering.
- **The premium trucker.** Foam fronts are out. Cotton twill, corduroy and suede fronts are in.
- **Fewer, slower drops.** Three to five pieces every six to eight weeks. A drop every two weeks 'turns scarcity into noise.'
- **Stores as clubhouses.** Pop-ups, run clubs and third spaces. Six in ten Millennials want retail that mixes community and shopping.
- **Western, done quiet.** Pearl snaps and a felt hat are back. Fringe and big buckles are out.

PRINT Type Report, 2026 · Foremost Hat on truckers · E-commerce Fast Lane on drops · Retail Technology Show, 2026 · Yahoo Shopping and E! on Western, 2026

What we take, part 1: the garment carries the idea.

- **Put the idea on it, not the logo.** 'thinking' on a cap, 'I love you, say it back' on a hoodie. Ours should be something locals already say.
- **Name the author.** Every drop credits a designer, ideally from Utah, the way A24 and Kilby Court do.
- **Print the edition size.** Dior did 8,500, Fermat did 75, the Jazz did 300. The number goes on the hem tag.
- **Let the make be the logo.** One technique and one named fabric per season, the way Bottega owns a weave and Satisfy owns MothTech.
- **Make one hero that isn't apparel.** OpenAI's $70 basketball, the New Yorker tote, Pendleton's 1916 Glacier Park blanket.

What we take, part 2: run it like a label, not a gift shop.

- **License and curate.** Like Pittsburgh, Only NY and Tokyo Tokyo, VSL owns the archive, the story and the official tag, and picks the maker.
- **Pull from the archive, not the logo file.** Pittsburgh used an 1800s merchant flag. Salt Lake has Saltair postcards, the 1899 Salt Palace and the grid.
- **Locals first.** Only NY and Detroit vs. Everybody sold to residents first. Visitors buy what locals wear.
- **Give it a room and a calendar.** A shelf at a place like Fice, and a release every six to eight weeks tied to the city's real seasons.
- **Tie a real number to the place.** A Great Salt Lake line without a measurable give to the lake is just pink.

Foundation: what every piece stands on.

The parent brand, the people who buy, the symbols that are ours, and what fabric and technique say before any graphic does.

The parent brand is America's Mountain City™.

The platform says you don't have to choose between city and mountains. Every piece in the line maps to one of its three pillars.

- **Both at Once.** City and mountain in the same place, no compromise. "A trail that ends two blocks from a sidewalk café."
- **Perpetual Momentum.** Jazz, Mammoth, RSL, Royals, festivals and art. "Already different than the last time you were here."
- **Frictionless.** "Forty minutes from gate to gondola." The airport is ten minutes from downtown.
- **What the merch inherits.** The palette and its names, the salt crystal, the contour texture, Ivar and Saans, and a voice that is confident, playful, friendly and genuine.

A sub-brand: keep the bones, bend on purpose.

The guide's Sub-Brands section is still empty, so this line can be the first one. Visit Salt Lake leads, and the line lives one step away from the campaign.

What we keep	What we bend, and why
The palette by hex, and its names as colorway names	The crystal alone as a label mark. The guide calls it a supporting asset; on a neck label it becomes the sub-brand's mark.
Filled crystal for embroidery, outline crystal for print	Dress the local, not the visitor. The guide casts people who "flew in for this"; the merch has to pass the local test first.
"Salt Lake," not "Salt Lake City"	No eyebrows. The guide's coordinate and elevation lines are dropped; if a number appears, it is the graphic.
The co-branding rule: VSL leads, a partner at about 80 percent weight	America's Mountain City™ moves to the hangtag. On the garment, the city name, the place and the pillar lines do the work.

VSL Brand Guide v6.0 R3, 2026 · Research 04, principles, 2026

Two buyers, one product: locals and visitors.

Locals buy pride and not looking like a tourist. Visitors buy proof of trip. Both buy the piece a local would actually wear.

Who	How many
SLC International passengers, 2025	28.16 million
Salt Lake County visitor spending, per year	$6.15 billion
Utah visitor spending, 2025, a record	$13.7 billion
Convention and event attendees, 2019	655,289
Utah skier visits, 2024 to 2025	6.5 million
Salt Lake County residents	About 1.2 million, median age about 32 (est.)

SLC International Airport, 2025 · Visit Salt Lake Annual Report, 2025 · Gardner Institute, 2026 · Visit Salt Lake Annual Report, 2019 · Gardner Institute, ski season report, 2025

People buy merch now as proof they were there.

- **23 percent** of travelers made a trip in the past year to buy something they couldn't get online. Skyscanner calls it pilgra-merch.
- **28 percent** of Gen Z are most proud of a limited-edition grocery tote from a destination.
- **63 percent** of Gen Z have bought something because of merch, and apparel is the favorite category at 62.6 percent.
- **3.5x.** That's how much more Gen Z and millennials spend in airport retail than Gen X and boomers.

Skyscanner via Euronews, 2026 · PPAI via Quad and Brandelity, 2024 to 2025 · ACI via Gulf Business, 2025



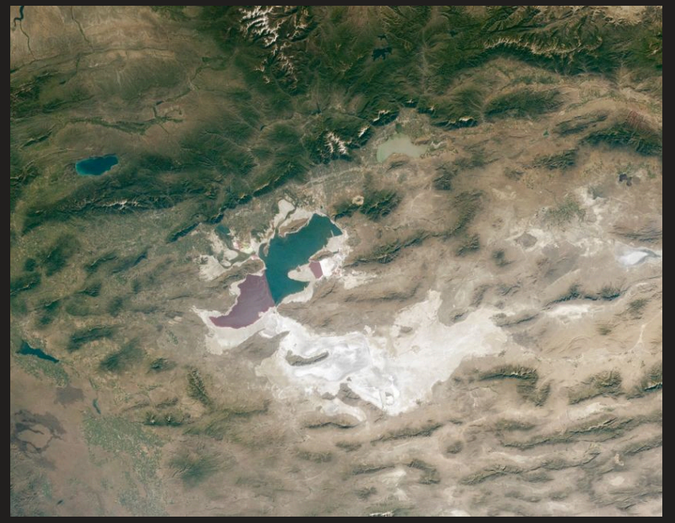
Ace Hotel Nalgene. A hotel-room object sold as merch.

The symbol bank, part one: the lake.

The Great Salt Lake is the deepest well we have, and almost none of it has been on a garment with any taste. Under all of it is Bonneville, the ice-age lake that filled the valley, and the salt flats west of the lake (verify).



Brine shrimp. Harvested since 1950 by 21 companies, a $10 to $60 million a year industry.



The pink north arm. Cut off by the railroad causeway, it runs 26 to 30 percent salt, and algae and archaea turn it pink.



Spiral Jetty. Robert Smithson, 1970, 1,500 feet of basalt, visible when the lake sits below 4,197 feet.



Salt. Halite grows in cubes, and the VSL mark is already a salt crystal.

Utah DWR, 2023 · Weber State and USU · UMFA and Artforum · KSL on the VSL brand, 2021

The symbol bank, part two: the city and the mountains.

Also in the bank: the longhorns that walk down Main Street every July for Pioneer Day, and 801, the original 1947 area code that locals still use as shorthand.



The grid. Laid out in 1847, and every address is a coordinate from one marker downtown (verify).



Wildflowers. Paintbrush in Albion Basin, red against pine green. Yid asked for more of these.



Bison. Put on Antelope Island in 1893 and rounded up in public every fall.



Lake-effect snow. About 5 percent of the snowfall, and the driest of it.

Research 04 symbol bank, 2026 · Church News, 2025 · Deseret News, 2024 · NASA Earth Observatory, 2001

Materials that signal: cotton weight, dye and fleece.

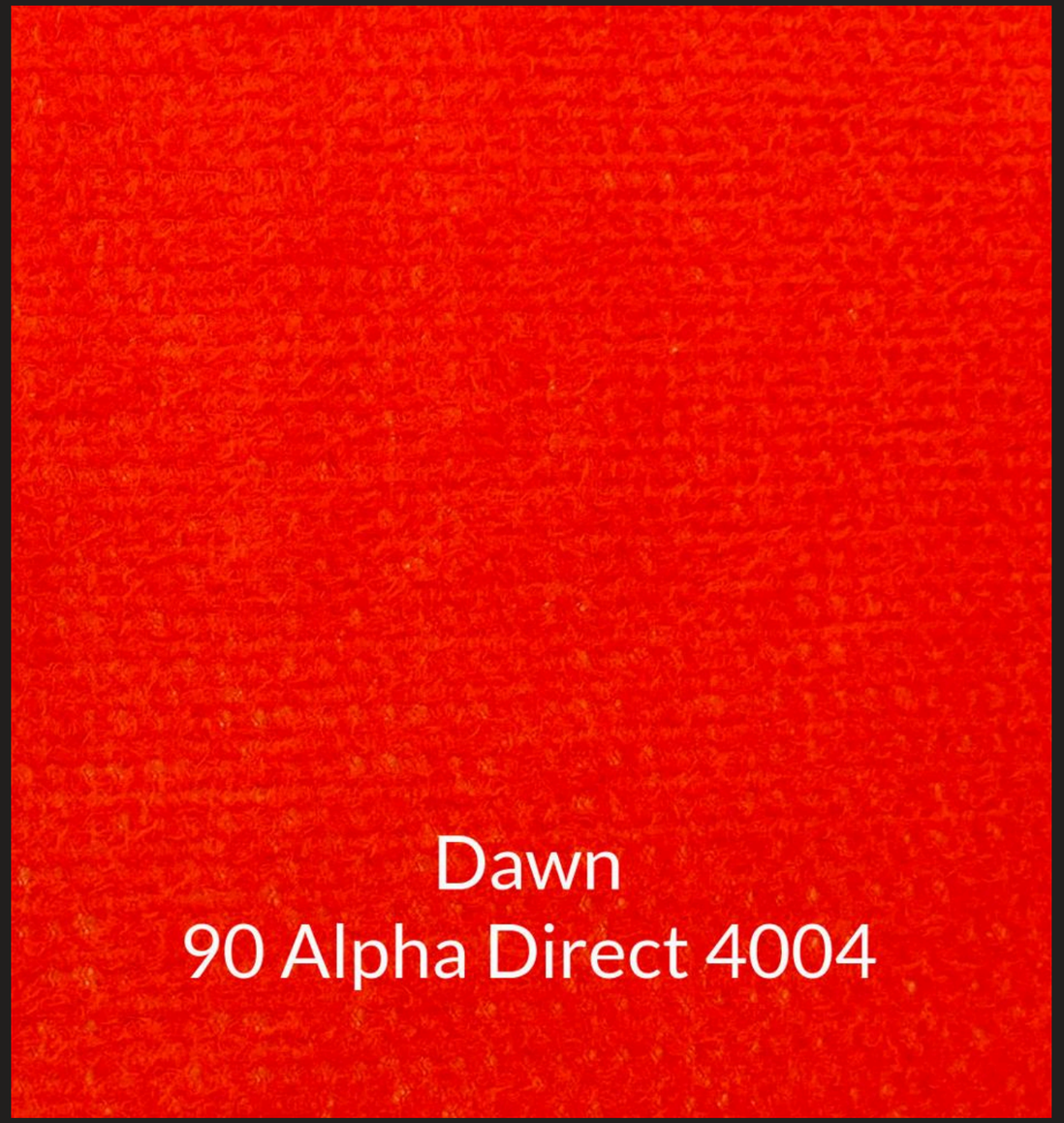
- **6.5 oz and up** is now the visible line between merch and clothes. A 5 oz promo blank reads as a free shirt.
- **Garment dye** is the fastest way to a color story that isn't commodity, for $2 to $5 more per blank.
- **14 oz cross-grain fleece** for the hoodie. At 50 units a heavyweight hoodie lands at $34 to $45 (est.).
- **Made in USA blanks** like Los Angeles Apparel roughly double the blank cost, but the claim is clean.



Technical materials, and why not Gore-Tex.

- **Polartec Alpha Direct.** Lofted insulation first built for US Special Operations. No liner, very breathable, snags easily. It's the Gain pullover.
- **Pertex Quantum Air.** Light, tightly woven nylon that trades some wind resistance for breathability. It's the strip on Gain.
- **3M Scotchlite reflective.** A safety material doing a design job, $2 to $6 a placement (est.). It's Five A.M.
- **Gore-Tex isn't for sale.** W. L. Gore licenses about 200 brands, and a DMO won't get a license.

Research 03, materials glossary, 2026 · Bergzeit Magazin on Gore-Tex licensing, via research 05



Polartec Alpha Direct 90. The loft is the garment.

Techniques say things before the graphic does.

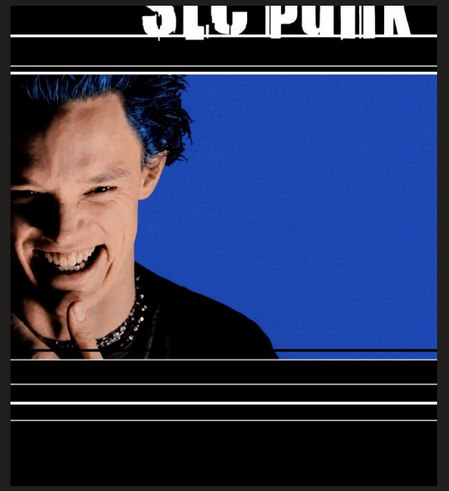
Embroidery, chain stitch, garment dye and good labels move a piece from souvenir to clothing. DTG and plain plastisol on a commodity blank keep it a souvenir. Cost runs from $ (under $2) to $$$$ (over $10) per placement.

Technique	Cost	What it says	Where we use it
Water-based screen print	$ to $$	Soft hand, vintage, feels like the shirt	It Came From, Vecino, Wild Rag
Plastisol screen print	$	Bright, opaque, a little plasticky	Nothing To Do hoodie
Embroidery and tackle twill	$$ to $$$$	Real clothing; varsity, earned	Club Deportivo crest and number
Chain stitch	$$$$	Artisan, Western, one of one	Paintbrush Yoke Shirt
Laser perforation and etching	$$$	Tonal and quiet	Five A.M. gussets, steel Two Arms
Reflective transfer	$$ to $$$	Running, night, technical	Five A.M., Gain back neck
Blind deboss and branding	One die, $150 to $300 (est.)	No ink, all material	Artemia, Two Arms, chore coat patch

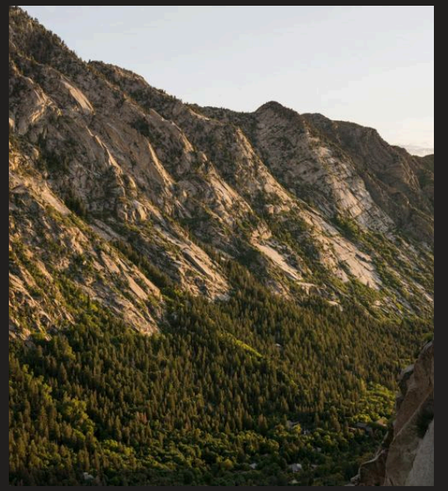
Research 05, decoration techniques, 2026 · Lane notes, Round 2

Five lanes, one line.

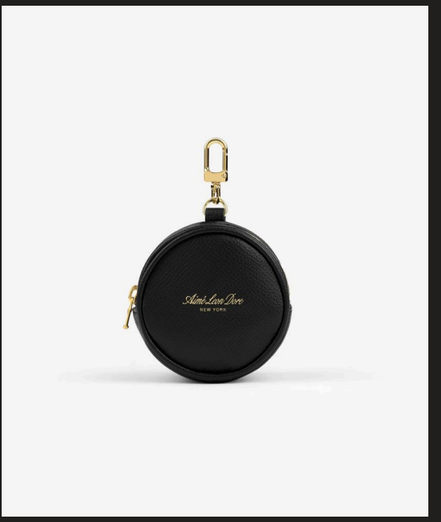
Thirteen pieces across five lanes. Each lane has its own voice, and all of them share a label, a palette and one test: would a local wear it?



Streetwear. Salt Lake is for the weird: band-merch logic from the city's punk and straight-edge scene.



Performance. We run on Salt Lake: training kit where the construction is the decoration.



Objects. The unseen things of a Salt Lake day, made like they matter.



Neo-Western. Rancher at 7,000 feet: quiet workwear and real craft.



Latino. Designed by Latino designers from Salt Lake County, with money going back to the community.

How we got here.

132 → 80 → 13

Five mood boards with 132 references: 80 kept, 47 cut. Two concept rounds of 15 pieces each: 12 in after the first round, 13 in after the second.

Salt Lake is for the weird.

This is a punk city. Straight-edge hardcore in the 90s, SLC Punk! in 1998, all-ages shows in a Kilby Court garage since 1999. The merch logic is band merch: one-color back prints, xerox grain, a phrase doing all the work.



Hand-lettered hardcore flyer, marker on pink



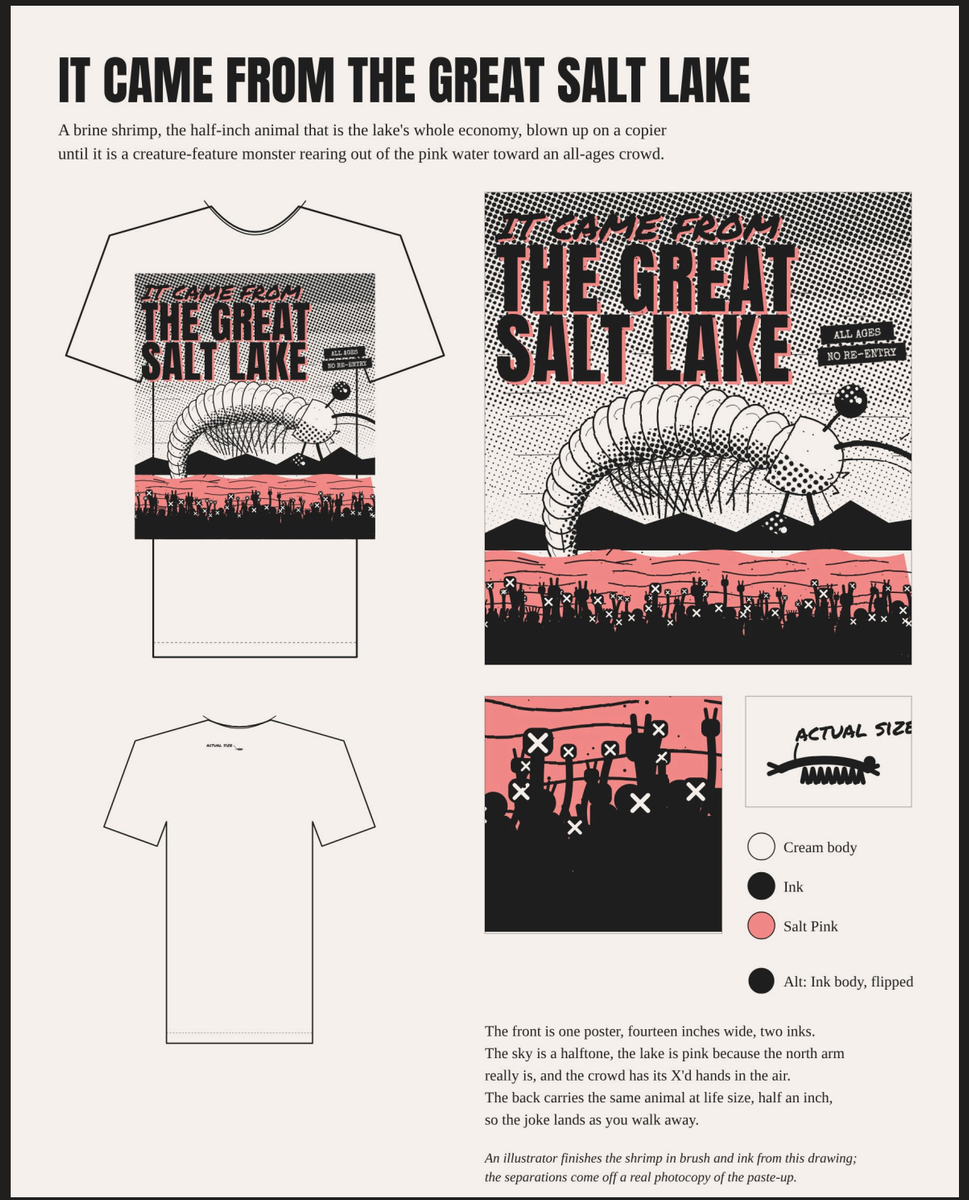
Online Ceramics, XXX on the sleeve



SLC Punk!, 1998



Brain Dead x Sunn O))), photocopy texture



It Came From the Great Salt Lake

The half-inch brine shrimp that runs the lake's economy, blown up on a copier into a 1950s creature-feature monster rearing out of the pink north arm toward an all-ages crowd. The same animal sits at life size on the upper back.

- **Blank:** 7 oz heavyweight boxy tee in Cream, so the print looks copied onto paper.
- **Technique:** 2-color water-based screen print, pink down first, ink on top with a deliberate 1/16 in offset, separations from a real photocopy.
- **Alt:** Ink body with the art flipped negative, so the halftone sky turns into stars.

$17 to $22 landed

> *Sea-Monkey from hell.*



Nothing To Do In Salt Lake

One sentence per hoodie, set in the SLC Punk! poster layout: half the line on a black bar, the rest at the bottom of an empty blue field. The empty blue is the nothing. Three phrases, three bodies, one drop.

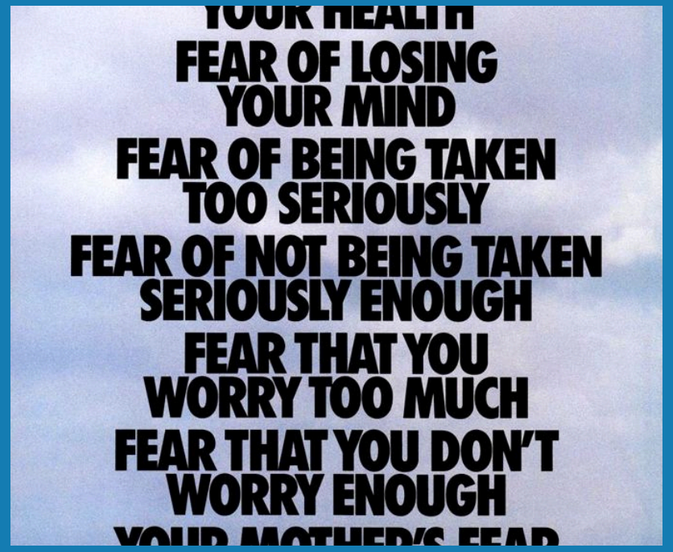
- **Ink:** NOTHING TO DO IN SALT LAKE.
- **Salt Pink:** SALT LAKE IS FOR THE WEIRD.
- **Cream:** DON'T MOVE TO SALT LAKE. Five alternates are in the notes.
- **Blank:** 14 oz cross-grain fleece, hood lined in poster blue.

$38 to $48 landed

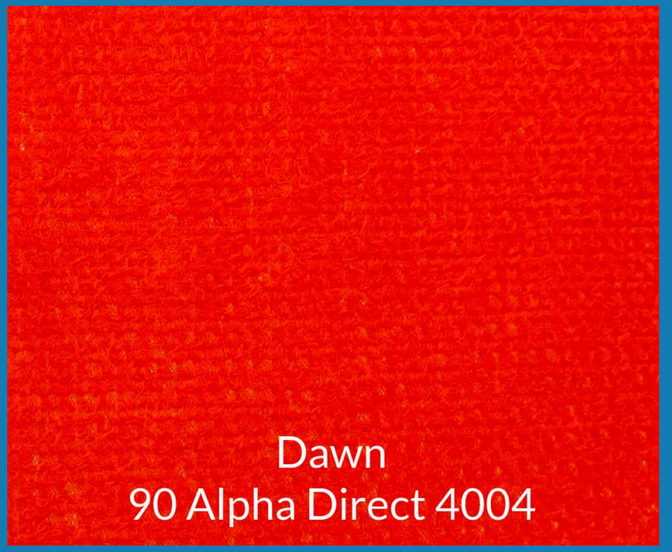
> *Yeah, that's what we said at 16, and then we went to Kilby every night.*

We run on Salt Lake.

A training ground with a zip code. People here run the Bonneville Shoreline before work, skin up in the dark, climb granite at lunch. The line should feel like race kit: honest fabric, reflective that only shows in headlights, copy that talks straight to the runner.



Nike and Wieden+Kennedy, 1990



Polartec Alpha Direct



Black Diamond in Little Cottonwood



The Bonneville Shoreline above the grid



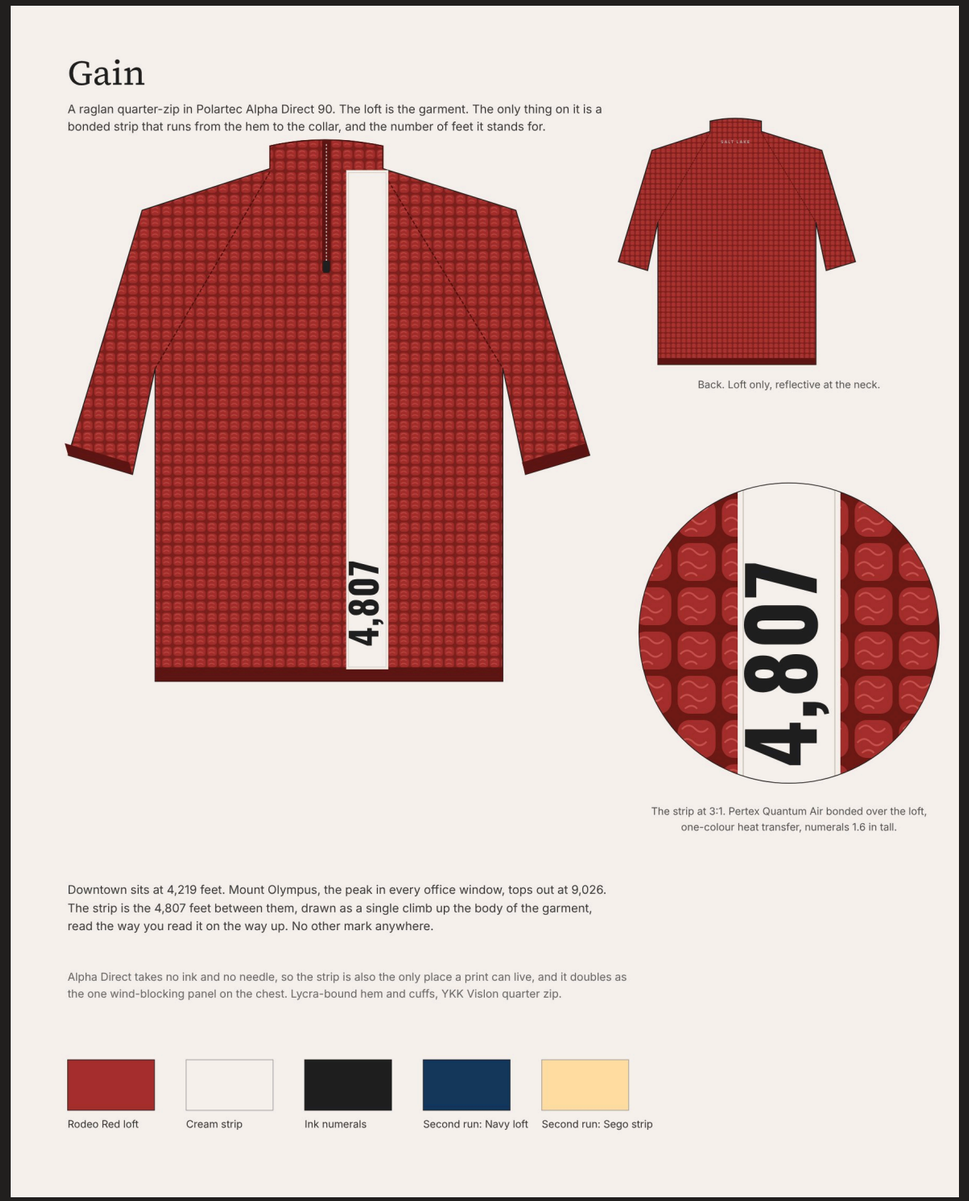
Five A.M.

"Nobody is watching at 5 a.m. That is the point." stacked huge across the chest of a bonded technical longsleeve, in reflective film. Grey on navy by day, white in a headlamp. It only says it when nobody is watching.

- **Blank:** 118 gsm recycled micro-eyelet jersey, bonded hem and cuffs, laser-perforated underarm gussets.
- **Technique:** 3M Scotchlite reflective transfer, 9 x 11 in chest block, Futura Extra Bold Condensed.
- **Verify first:** solid film can board the chest, so sample a 50 percent halftone of the film next to solid.

$38 to $55 landed

> *That is the Shoreline at five in March.*



Gain

An Alpha Direct quarter-zip with one bonded strip running from hem to collar beside the zip. The only type is 4,807, set tall and reading upward: the vertical from the valley floor to the summit of Mount Olympus, the climb as the garment.

- **Blank:** Polartec Alpha Direct 90, raglan quarter-zip, Rodeo Red.
- **Technique:** the number is heat-transferred onto a bonded Pertex strip, because the loft takes no ink or needle.
- **Sourcing:** Alpha Direct needs a converter or a Black Diamond or Kühl partner at small minimums.

$75 to $110 landed

> *4,807. From where? Then they look up at Olympus.*

The unseen objects of a Salt Lake day.

Not souvenirs. The things you touch between the lift line and the kitchen: the rack your board hangs on, the pouch with your keys and transit card, the record you put on when the snow comes down. Designed like they matter, with the lake as the raw material.



The lake from the ISS, pink and blue



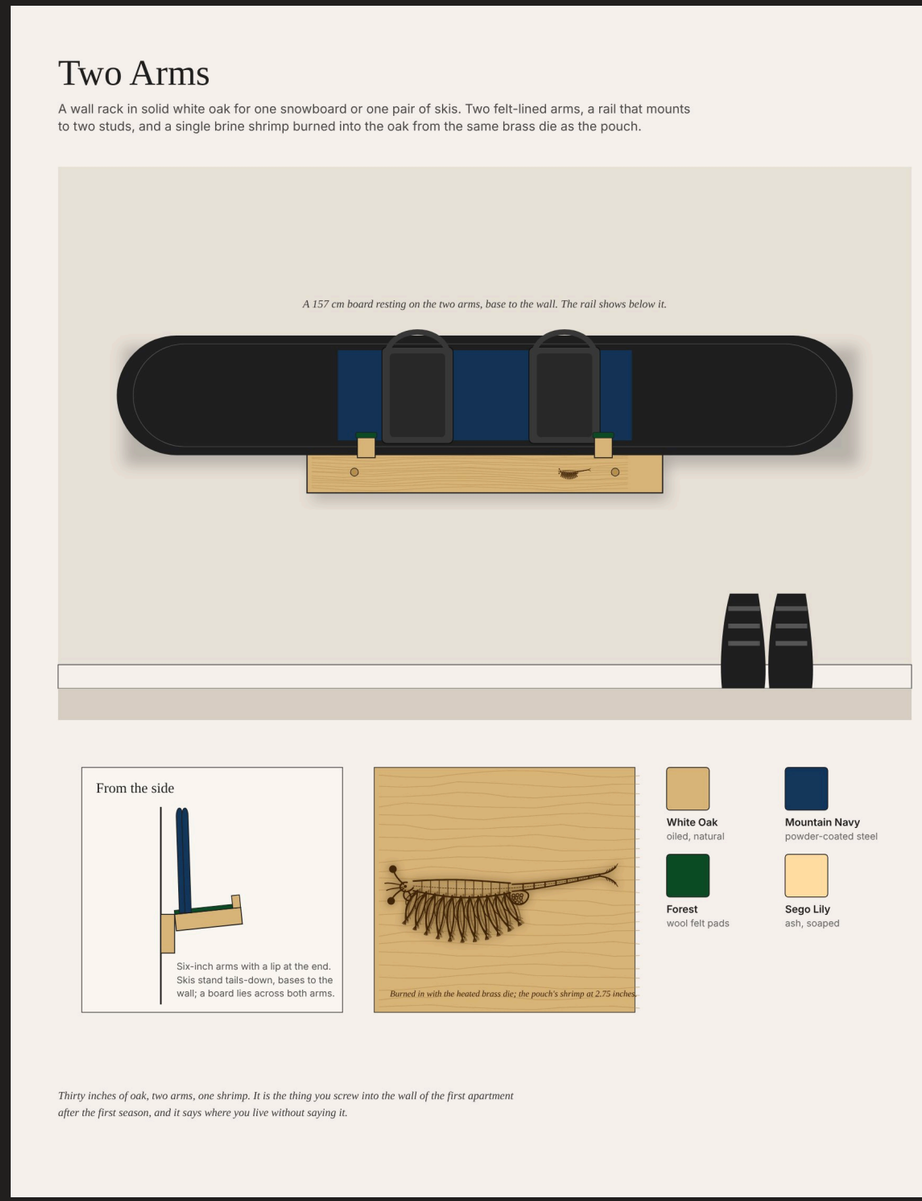
District Vision eyewear pouch



A24 soundtrack vinyl



Artemia franciscana



Two Arms

A 30-inch white oak rail with two felt-topped arms. It holds one snowboard across or a pair of skis tails-down. The only mark is the brine shrimp burned into the end of the rail with the same brass die that debosses the pouch.

- **Material:** solid white oak, or powder-coated steel in Mountain Navy.
- **Technique:** brass branding die, about $150 to $300 once, shared with the pouch.
- **Where it sells:** online and in a few shops with local shipping. Too big for a visitor-center shelf.

$35 to $75 landed

> *That's a sea monkey on my ski rack.*

Field Recordings, Great Salt Lake

A 12-inch record of ten sounds from one Salt Lake winter, recorded on location and left alone.
The sleeve is an aerial of the Spiral Jetty in the pink north arm. The disc is poured pink over blue at the causeway angle.



Field Recordings, Great Salt Lake

A

1. Wind across the north arm, Rozel Point	6:12
2. Wildcat lift, bottom terminal, Alta	4:40
3. Snow on a windshield, I-80 westbound	5:30
4. Cold start and a scraper, Sugar House	3:52
5. TRAX doors, Gallivan Plaza	2:48

B

1. Avalanche control, Little Cottonwood	4:15
2. Brine flies lifting off Antelope Island	3:05
3. Wind through the Saltair pavilion	4:58
4. Gulls and a train on the causeway	3:20
5. Salt crust underfoot, Spiral Jetty	7:00

Recorded by [Recordist], winter 2026. Mastered for vinyl in Salt Lake.
Sleeve after Robert Smithson, Spiral Jetty, 1970, with the Holt/Smithson Foundation.
Visit Salt Lake. VSL 001. 180 gram, 33 1/3 rpm.



The label at size: 100 mm, uncoated, the jetty printed as built.

Salt Pink
north arm, disc

Sky
south arm, disc

Light Pink
the playa

Ink
the jetty

Every disc pours a little differently, so every copy is a slightly different lake. The recordist is credited on the front and the back of every pressing. The sleeve is printed on reverse board, so the pink sits matte and chalky.

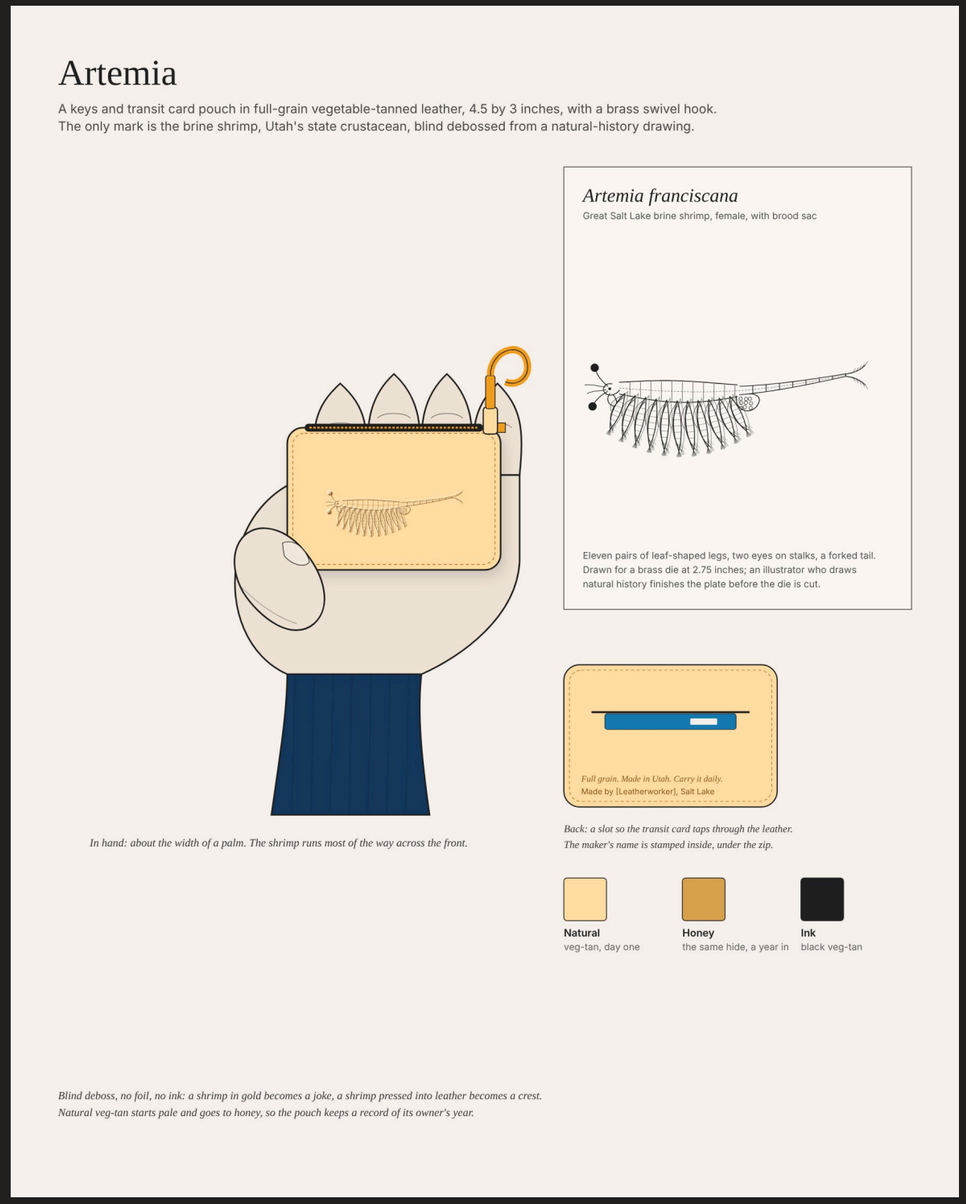
Field Recordings, Great Salt Lake

A 12-inch LP of ten real Salt Lake sounds: wind on the north arm, the lift sheaves at Alta, snow on a windshield on I-80, a TRAX chime, avalanche control, brine flies, gulls and a train on the causeway. Spiral Jetty is the label. The recordist is credited on every pressing.

- **Pressing:** split pink-over-blue vinyl. Plants rarely press fewer than 100, so the test is 100 with 50 held for gifting and press.
- **Permissions:** Holt/Smithson Foundation for the jetty, releases from Alta and UTA. A no-jetty version is in the notes.
- **Lead time:** 10 to 16 weeks at the plant, so it is booked for the season it describes.

$25 to $35 each at 100

> *A2 is the Wildcat lift. I'd know that hum anywhere.*



Artemia

A keys-and-transit-card zip pouch in veg-tan leather with brass hardware and a tap-through card slot. The only mark is a natural-history drawing of Artemia franciscana, blind-debossed. No foil, no ink, no logo.

- **Material:** veg-tan leather in Natural, Honey or Ink, brass zip.
- **Technique:** blind deboss from the shared brass die.
- **Verify first:** a natural-history illustrator redraws the shrimp by hand before the die is cut, or it reads as a bug.

$28 to $45 landed

> *Is that a brine shrimp? Sea monkeys.*

Rancher at 7,000 feet.

Western is having its biggest moment in decades, and the version that works is restraint: one chain-stitched motif, a quilt hidden in a lining, a single-color drawing on a rag. Salt Lake earns it honestly, with a longhorn drive through downtown and a bison herd on the island.



Bode, quilt jacket



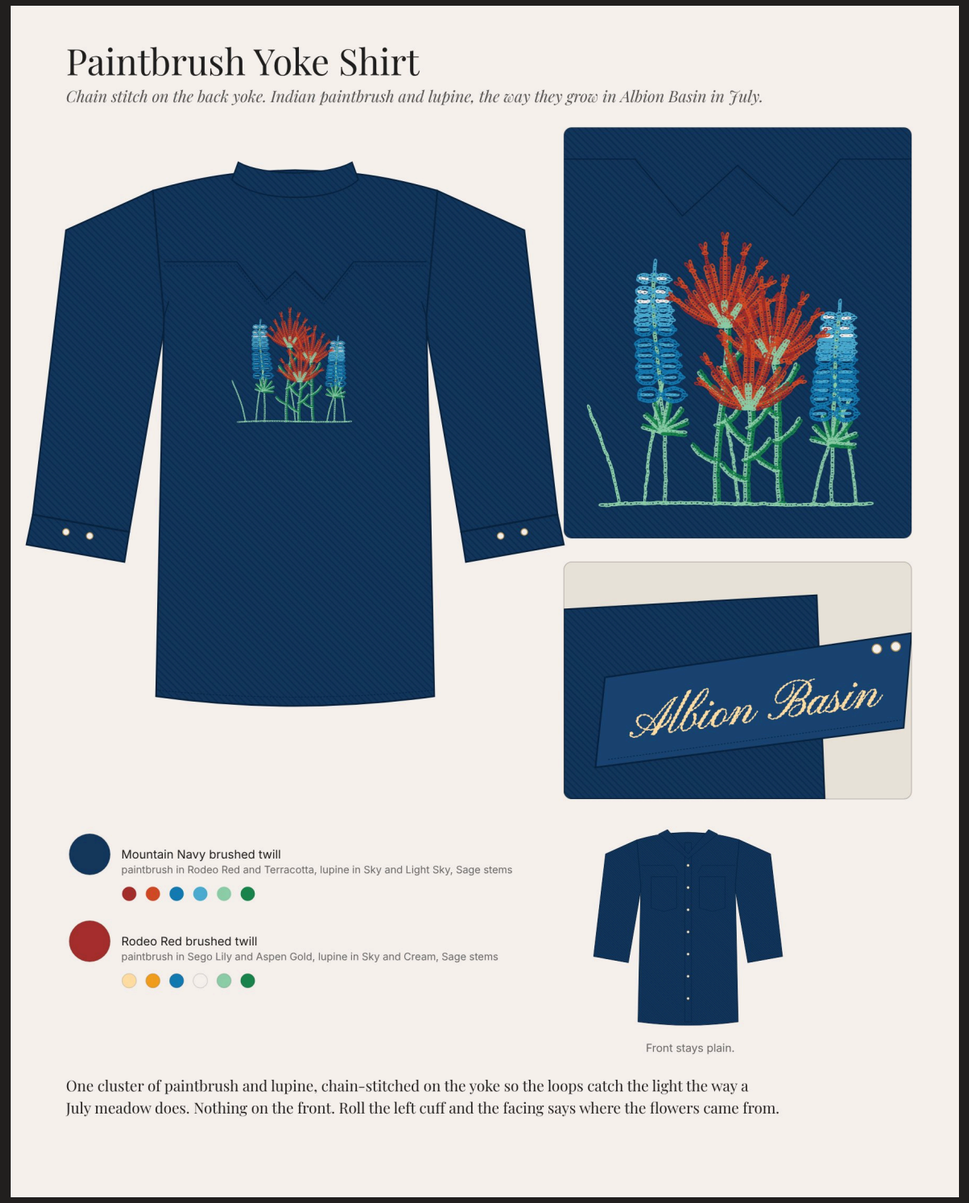
Fort Lonesome, chain stitch in progress



Antelope Island roundup



Indian paintbrush, Albion Basin



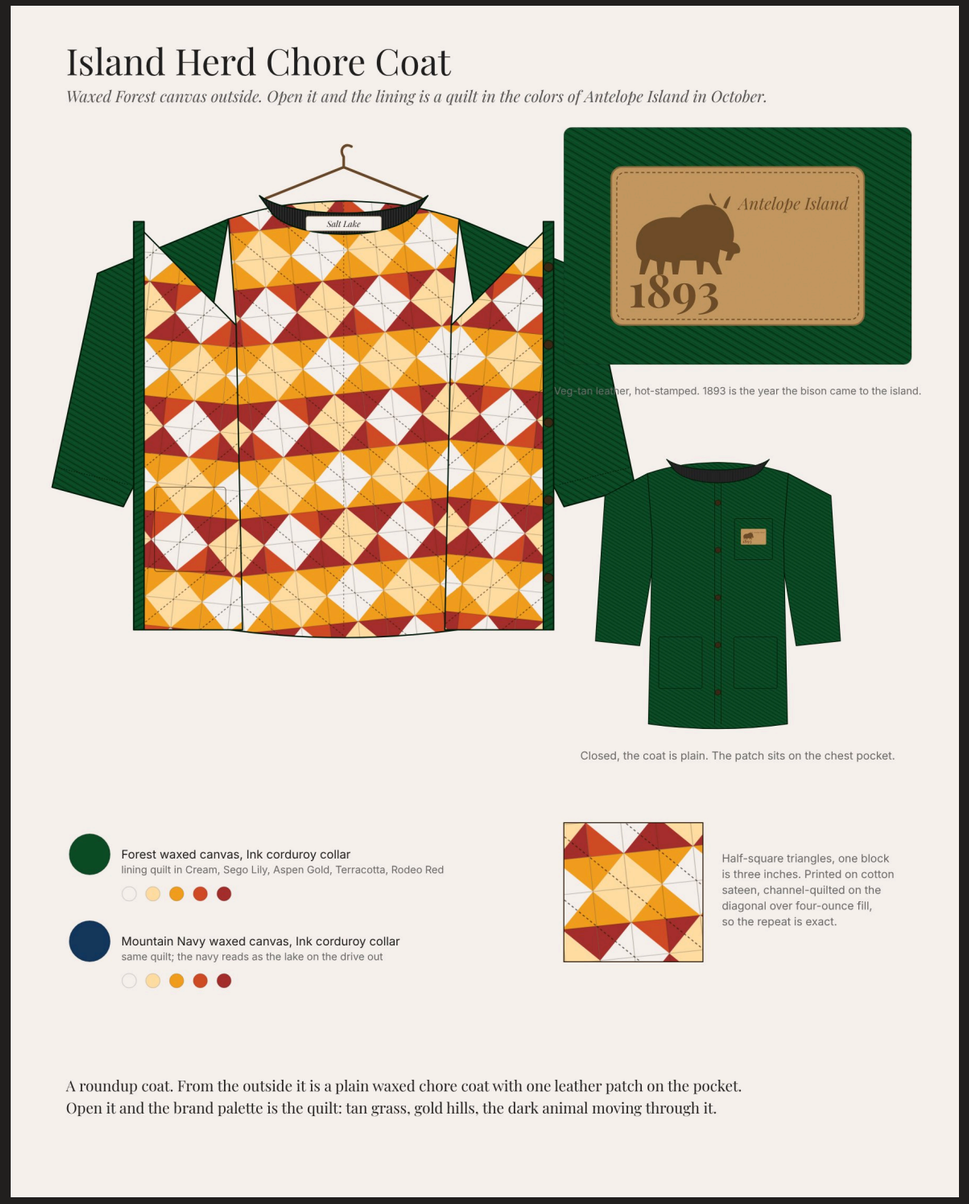
Paintbrush Yoke Shirt

A Mountain Navy brushed-twill snap shirt with one chain-stitched cluster of Indian paintbrush and lupine on the back yoke, and nothing else. Roll the left cuff and "Albion Basin" is stitched in script inside it.

- **Blank:** 7 oz brushed cotton twill snap shirt, pearl snaps with copper rims.
- **Technique:** chain stitch, six thread colors, 4.5 x 3.5 in on the yoke.
- **Colorways:** Mountain Navy, Rodeo Red. Summer alt in chambray.

$48 to $75 landed

> *That's the paintbrush up at Albion in July.*



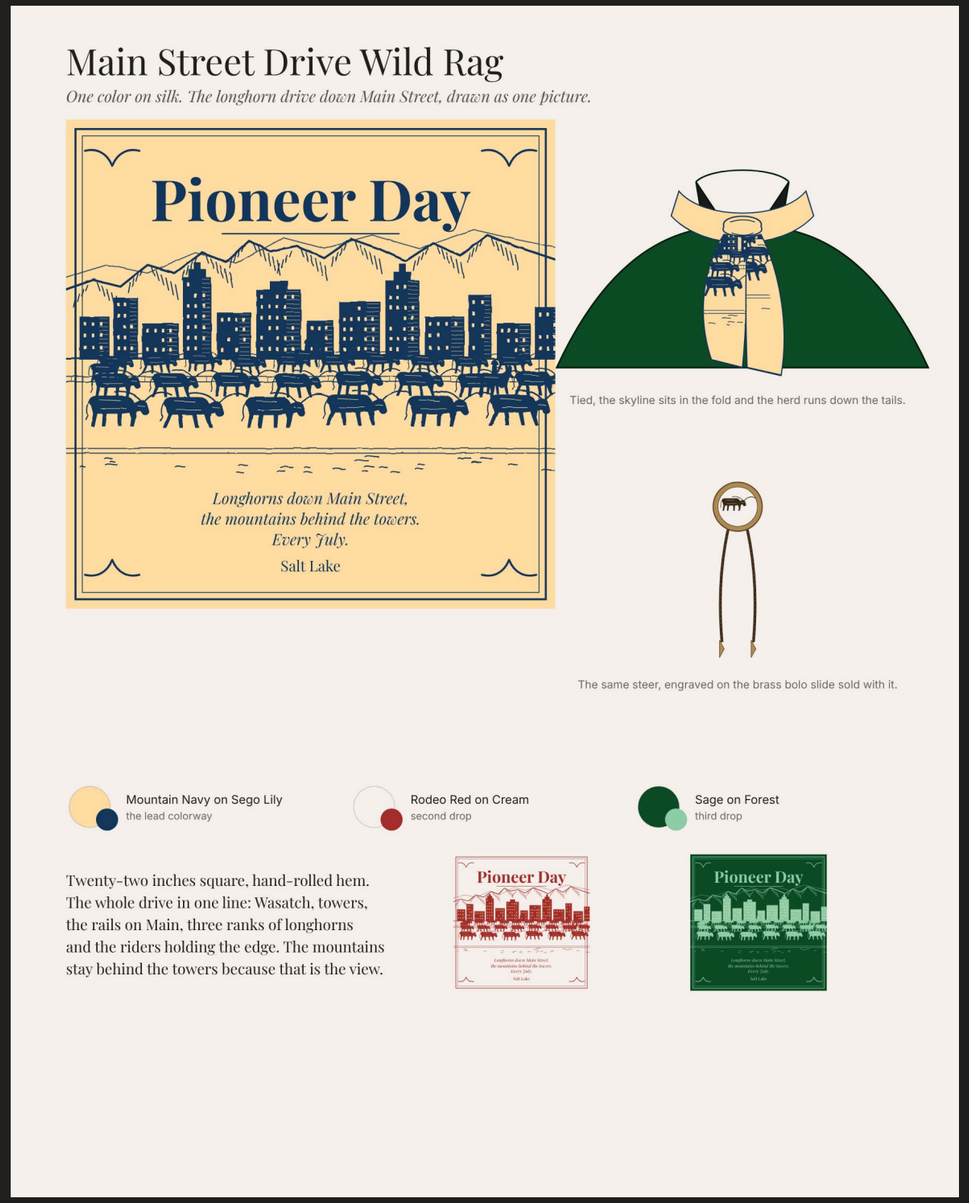
Island Herd Chore Coat

A plain waxed Forest canvas chore coat. Open it and the lining is a half-square-triangle quilt in Cream, Sego Lily, Aspen Gold, Terracotta and Rodeo Red. One leather patch: a bison, "Antelope Island," and 1893, the year the bison came to the island.

- **Route at 50:** a stock waxed chore blank, re-lined, with a leather patch. Full cut-and-sew is not a sensible 50-unit test.
- **Date:** 1893 is the herd date. The roundup's own founding year is unsettled, so it stays off the patch.

$85 to $130 landed

> *That's the island herd.*



Main Street Drive Wild Rag

A 22-inch wild rag with one single-color drawing: longhorns and riders coming down Main Street, downtown towers and two Wasatch ridgelines behind them. Headlined Pioneer Day, which needs no license.

- **Blank:** silk twill, or cotton for a lower price.
- **Colorways:** Navy on Sego Lily, Red on Cream, Sage on Forest.
- **Set:** pairs with a brass bolo slide engraved with the same steer.

$14 to $24 silk

> *They really drive cattle down Main?*

Latin life in the West.

Not Hispanic Heritage Month. Latin life as it is already lived here: a lowrider under the Wasatch, La Barra Real at RSL, a jaripeo at the Fairpark. The words come from the community, and the line is designed by Latino designers from Salt Lake County with a share of revenue going back.



Paisa Boys, Club Deportivo



Mister Cartoon, by Estevan Oriol



Lowrider at Gallivan Center



Lotería boards









Salt Pink home.
Forest trim and twill, Cream keyline.

Rodeo Red match-day alt, Navy trim.
Only with La Barra Real in the room.

A club jersey for a club that is the city. The crest is a 3.5 inch embroidered badge: a brine shrimp curled over the Wasatch, the lake in pink under the ridge, 801 at the foot, merrowed in Cream. Eight twill stars run down the sleeves, one for each place the community lives: West Valley, Rose Park, Glendale, Magna, Kearns, Midvale, South Salt Lake, Taylorsville. The back is Salt Lake in blackletter over 801 in two-color tackle twill, cut big enough to read from the far side of the parking lot. Pink is a real fútbol color and it is the lake, so it is ours. The match-day alt only exists if the barra wants it.

Crest, blackletter and shrimp are redrawn by a Salt Lake County embroidery digitizer and letterer. The badge is also sold on its own.

Club Deportivo Salt Lake

A supporters' jersey for a club that is the city itself. Salt Pink with Forest trim, an embroidered crest of a brine shrimp over the Wasatch ridge with 801 at the foot, neighborhood stars on the sleeves, SALT LAKE arched over 801 on the back.

- **Crest:** 3.5 in embroidered patch, sewn on, also sold alone.
- **Back:** two-color tackle twill.
- **Match-day alt:** Rodeo Red and Mountain Navy, only with La Barra Real co-signing.
- **Open:** 801 also covers Provo and Ogden; the star count is a community count, decided by the community designers.

$26 to $60 landed

> *Which club is that? Nosotros.*









Ink body, white ink.

Forest body, Cream ink, second run.

Mountain Navy body, Salt Pink ink, Vecina.

One word, thirteen inches wide, nothing else on the shirt. Vecino is what the West Side calls itself and what Comunidades Unidas and Centro Civico say in their own copy. It belongs to every nationality here and nobody owns it as a brand. The hand is a fine-line script in one continuous stroke: a liner on the up strokes, pressure on the down strokes, the tail of the o swinging back under the word as the underline. The women's cut is Vecina, one letter changed by the same hand. 801 sits at the back neck in the same line.

This drawing is a stand-in. A Salt Lake County letterer draws the final in ink on vellum, and the strike-off is approved on the actual blank.

Vecino

One word, neighbor, across the chest in a single fine line, drawn by hand. Vecina on the women's cut. 801 at the back neck.

- **Why this word:** Paisa and Hyna belong to other brands, Raza carries political weight VSL has no standing to use, Familia and Barrio are on a thousand tees. Vecino belongs to everyone and nobody owns it.
- **Technique:** one-color white water-based print, 230 mesh, the letterer approves the strike-off.

$10 to $20 landed

> *That's it? Yeah, that's it.*



Lotería Salt Lake

Six lotería cards on the back of a black tee: El Trax, La Montaña, El Taco, La Sal, El Camarón, La Troca. Every card number is a local fact. El Camarón alone on the chest.

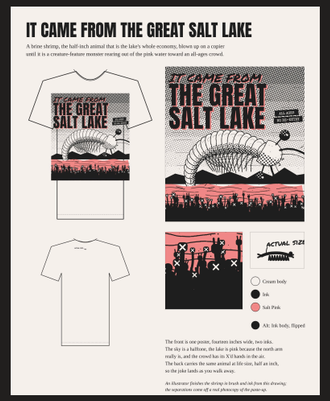
- **Technique:** flat spot colors on a cream underbase, no halftones, so it feels like card stock.
- **Second drop:** El Lowrider.
- **Rule:** if the illustrator is not from here, cut it.

$28 to $38 landed

> *Where's El Lowrider?*

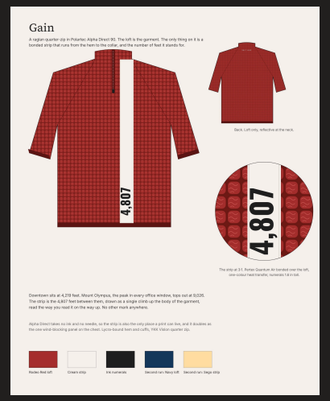
The line, Round 1.

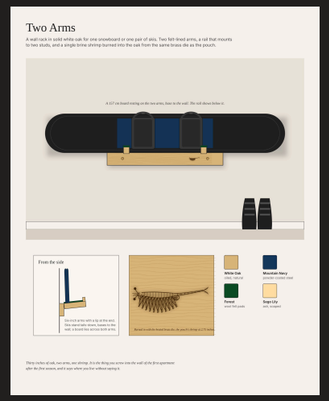
Thirteen pieces across five lanes, kept from fifteen in Round 2 and from 132 references on the mood boards.

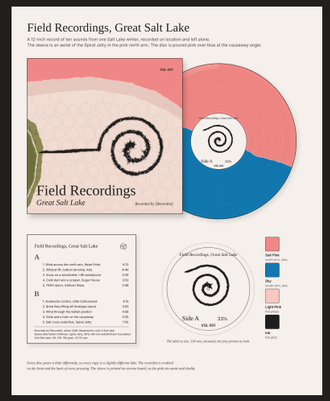


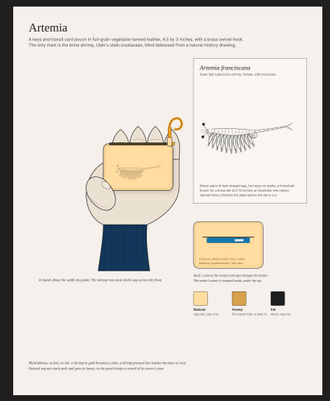




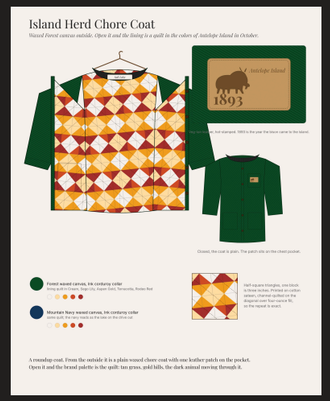


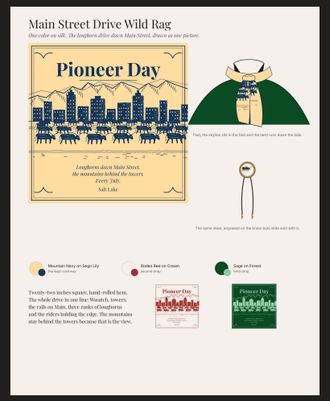


















Each lane drops in its own room, on its own day.

Not at the airport. Each lane launches where its people already are, on a date the city already keeps. This is a proposal for you to rearrange.

Lane	When	Where
Streetwear	An all-ages show night	A Kilby Court-style pop-up, then online
Performance	First snow, before dawn	A run club meetup on the Bonneville Shoreline, then online
Objects	Winter, with the LP	Record shops and a few design shops, then online
Neo-Western	Pioneer Day, July 24	A downtown pop-up near the parade route
Latino	El Grito, September 16	With Centro Civico Mexicano, at the community's own event

The build: make it, price it, clear it.

How a 50-unit test gets made, what it costs, how long it takes, and what has to be cleared before the first sample.

The first run is a 50-unit test.

50

Fifty of each piece is enough to learn which lanes sell, to whom, at what price, and which makers deliver. It isn't enough to make money, and it isn't meant to.

What each piece costs to make at 50.

Landed cost per unit at a 50-unit test, from the lane notes. Every figure is an estimate until a maker quotes it. Retail pricing waits for Round 2, as you asked.

Piece	Route at 50	Landed per unit (est.)
It Came From the Great Salt Lake	Heavyweight blank, 2-color water-based print	$17 to $22
Nothing To Do in Salt Lake hoodie	14 oz blank, lined hood, plastisol	$38 to $48
Five A.M.	Stock tech blank, reflective film, laser gussets	$38 to $55
Gain	Domestic tech shop, our pattern	$75 to $110
Two Arms	Salt Lake woodshop, white oak	$45 to $75
Field Recordings, Great Salt Lake	US pressing plant, 100 minimum	$50 to $70 at 50; $25 to $35 at 100
Artemia	Salt Lake leatherworker	$28 to $45
Paintbrush Yoke Shirt	Stock snap shirt, machine chain stitch	$48 to $75
Island Herd Chore Coat	Stock waxed chore coat, re-lined, leather patch	$85 to $130
Main Street Drive Wild Rag	Silk twill, 1-color water-based print	$14 to $24
Club Deportivo Salt Lake jersey	LA cut-and-sew, patch and twill	$45 to $60
Vecino	LAA 1801GD, 1-color water-based print	$15 to $20
Lotería Salt Lake	LAA 1801GD, 12-color spot print	$28 to $38

Lane notes, Round 2, 2026 · Research 05, small-run economics and pricing, 2026

Production lanes and timeline.

A holiday and ski-season drop wants product in hand by early November. Working back from that date, the slowest lane starts in spring.

Production lane	Pieces	Concept to product in hand	Start by
Decorated blank, domestic printer	It Came From, Nothing To Do, Vecino, Lotería, Wild Rag	6 to 10 weeks	Late August
Stock blank plus a specialist step	Five A.M., Paintbrush Yoke Shirt, Island Herd Chore Coat	6 to 10 weeks plus the specialist's queue (verify)	June (verify)
Domestic cut-and-sew	Club Deportivo jersey, Gain	4 to 7 months	April
Local makers	Two Arms, Artemia	Not in our research yet (verify)	Spring, after a quote (verify)
Pressing plant	Field Recordings, Great Salt Lake	10 to 16 weeks at the plant, after recording and permission	Plant booked by mid-July

Research 05, realistic calendar, 2026 · Lane notes, Round 2, 2026

Starting the manufacturer conversation.

Bring a tech pack, quantities by style, color and size, a target landed cost and retail, the drop date, vector art with Pantones, and the origin claims we plan to make. Then ask each maker for the one test below.

Piece	Verify before sampling
It Came From the Great Salt Lake	A press proof of the halftone sky at 110 mesh, water-based on cream. Do the small dots fill in?
Nothing To Do in Salt Lake hoodie	Will the blank maker sell the hoodie with the hood lining left off, or in our color?
Five A.M.	Does an 11 in block of reflective film stiffen the chest and crack? Test a 50 percent halftone against solid.
Gain	Does the bond hold a 26 in Pertex strip to the loft through 20 washes? Test a 6 in strip first.
Two Arms	Does the burned shrimp keep its eleven pairs of legs at 2.75 in on oak?
Field Recordings, Great Salt Lake	Written permission from the Holt/Smithson Foundation, plus recording releases from Alta and UTA.
Artemia	Does the die hold the leg hatching at 2.75 in? Strike one on scrap veg-tan.
Paintbrush Yoke Shirt	Can a multi-head chain-stitch house hold six thread changes in a 4.5 in motif at 50? Sew-out on our twill.
Island Herd Chore Coat	Print and quilt one yard of the lining; if it reads as a motel bedspread, the piece fails. Confirm we can relabel the blank.
Main Street Drive Wild Rag	A strike-off of water-based ink on the actual silk, washed twice.
Club Deportivo Salt Lake jersey	Clearance on 801 as an apparel mark, and a sit-down with La Barra Real before sample one.
Vecino	Print the hairline test strip on the actual blank; the result sets the thinnest stroke.
Lotería Salt Lake	A wet-on-wet test of twelve spot colors on the cream underbase on black.

Research 05, first manufacturer conversation, 2026 · Lane notes, Round 2, 2026

Legal and licensing.

General information, not legal advice. Counsel and a CPA should be in the room early.

Issue	The rule	What we do
Olympic marks	The Ted Stevens Act protects "Olympic," the rings, ring look-alikes, wordplay and Games marks, with no proof of confusion needed.	Nothing on product. 2002 shows up only as history.
"The Greatest Snow on Earth"	A federally registered mark owned by the State of Utah.	Off limits. We use the snow science instead.
State tourism brand	The Utah Office of Tourism's marks need written permission.	Not used. "Utah" as a word is fine.
"Made in USA" and "Made in Utah"	FTC standard: all or virtually all made here. Penalties up to about $53,000 per violation, website banners included.	Say "Designed and decorated in Salt Lake." Rewrite the Artemia stamp.
UBIT	Souvenir sales by a nonprofit can be taxed as unrelated business income. Passive royalties generally aren't.	License the line for a royalty. Get a CPA opinion.
Sales tax and labels	Retail sales are generally taxable. Labels need fiber, origin, care and an RN number.	A Utah sales tax license (verify); labels in every tech pack.
Permissions	Holt/Smithson Foundation for the jetty, Alta and UTA for recordings, 801 clearance, La Barra Real.	Ask before sample one, not after.

USOPC guidelines, via research 05 · USPTO Reg. 3031199, 2005 · FTC Made in USA Labeling Rule, 2021 · Adler and Colvin, UBIT primer

Partners and credits.

VSL is licensor and curator, not author. The people who finish the work get their names on it.

Who	What they do	Pieces
Latino designers from Salt Lake County	Design the lane, with West Valley, Rose Park and Glendale first	Club Deportivo, Vecino, Lotería
A community letterer and illustrator	Redraw every line, script and card in their own hand	Vecino, Lotería, the jersey's SALT LAKE
Centro Civico Mexicano or Comunidades Unidas	Revenue share, with the org named on the hangtag	The Latino lane
La Barra Real	Co-sign the match-day kit	Club Deportivo jersey
Illustrators and letterers	The brush-and-ink shrimp, the natural-history plate, the dry-brush cattle drive, the hand-lettered titles	It Came From, Artemia, Two Arms, Wild Rag
A Utah field recordist	Record the LP, credited on the front	Field Recordings, Great Salt Lake
Makers	A Salt Lake woodshop and leatherworker, a chain-stitch house, a Utah laser shop, a local sewing shop, a county embroidery digitizer	Two Arms, Artemia, Paintbrush Yoke, Five A.M., Island Herd, the jersey crest

Lane notes, Round 2, 2026 · Research 04, principles, 2026

Decisions needed, and what happens next.

- **The structure.** License the line to a Utah maker for a royalty, or run it in-house. We recommend licensing because of UBIT, once a CPA confirms.
- **The first pieces.** Which of the thirteen go in the 50-unit test. The cheapest to learn from are Vecino, It Came From and the Wild Rag.
- **The irony call.** VSL has to want NOTHING TO DO IN SALT LAKE on a hoodie. DON'T MOVE TO SALT LAKE is a new third phrase and needs Yid's yes.
- **Three asks before sample one.** The Holt/Smithson Foundation on the jetty, La Barra Real on the jersey, and a signed Latino design team and partner org.
- **Round 2.** Real makers and written quotes, a name and lockup for the sub-brand, and pricing for the VSL team.